

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Bible Study Methods

Bible R.E.C.A.P.

A free resource from JesusOnline.

Read or share online: equip.jesonline.com/channels/church/bible-study-methods/bible-recap

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

Bible R.E.C.A.P.

All Scripture is inspired by God and is useful to teach us what is true and to make us realize what is wrong in our lives. It corrects us when we are wrong and teaches us to do what is right. God uses it to prepare and equip his people to do every good work.

— 2 Timothy 3:16-17 (NLT)

When we habitually renew our minds with the truth of God's Word and faithfully follow His directions and instructions, we become more Christ-like.

The Word of God is the language of the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit will open our minds to understand the Word and empower us to obey and live out its truth. Within its pages, He reveals what is true and exposes what is not.

Whenever you read the Bible, be prayerful, asking the Holy Spirit to guide you into all truth (John 16:13). Then trust His guidance and ask yourself questions: What does this mean? How does this apply to my life? The following method will help you ask key questions.

Five Questions to Ask

When you read the Bible, you can ask one or more of the following five questions.

- **R** — Is there a **revelation** about God that I should embrace?
- **E** — Is there an **example** I should follow or avoid?
- **C** — Is there a **command** I should obey?
- **A** — Is there something I need to **apply** to my life?
- **P** — Is there a **promise** I should claim?

An Example

John 3:16 is a revelation of God's unconditional love in His Son, so you can highlight the verse with orange (Revelation). John 13:34 is a command to love one another, so you can highlight the verse with red (Command). John 14:21 is a promise that Jesus

will manifest Himself to us if we love and obey Him, so you can highlight the verse with purple (Promise).

Highlight Bible passages and code them with a R.E.C.A.P. letter for future review in your Bible notes.

Read Prayerfully

As you read, talk to God about everything you are thinking. It may be helpful to write down what you have discovered from the reading and your reflection. Be mindful of His presence and His love. Thank Him for what you are reading, learning, and thinking. Give Him your focused attention and concentration.